

Chapter 23_3 - Divorce Certificate

Zhou Qiongqiong's shock could only be considered a minor episode. When the three of them chatted about other things afterward, Zhou Qiongqiong maintained an absent-minded appearance throughout.

The CP¹ she had been rooting for had fucking ended tragically before she'd even started shipping them seriously. What kind of CP poison was she!

Sigh, she had thought Yan Lin and Feng Yue could persist. After all, that was twelve years of feelings—could they really just end it like that?

Zhou Qiongqiong looked at Feng Yue, who was chatting enthusiastically with her senior sister, and thought to herself again.

Maybe... they really could just end it like that.

She had witnessed Feng Yue's persistence in matters of the heart, so when she saw that Feng Yue could decisively cut things off when needed, she admired her for it.

Zhou Qiongqiong had all sorts of chaotic thoughts by herself, and finally even suggested going to a bar to celebrate Feng Yue's return to singlehood.

Of course, Feng Yue, who couldn't drink alcohol, still found an excuse to refuse. In the end, the three of them had to settle for buying three bottles of drinks from the convenience store next to the theater and hastily celebrated.

"Ugh, this really lacks any sense of ceremony!" Zhou Qiongqiong tightened her bottle cap and sighed deeply.

Feng Yue tilted her head back and took a gulp of her drink, managing to drink it with a heroic feeling. "I think it's great! As long as I'm with friends, everything feels ceremonial!"

"I agree." With that, Wen Zhen clinked bottles with Feng Yue.

Seeing this, Zhou Qiongqiong also came over insisting on clinking bottles too. Seeing this, Feng Yue felt mischievous and laughingly hid her bottle behind her back, just refusing to let Zhou Qiongqiong clink with her.

Three young women in the prime of their youth were laughing and playing around on the street outside the convenience store, attracting quite a few sideways glances from passersby.

Naturally, this also attracted the attention of someone in a black Cayenne² parked by the roadside.

Yan Lin had come to this area to discuss business. After finishing her business and wanting to leave, she saw Feng Yue walking out of the convenience store with two other friends.

The three seemed to be celebrating something, even raising their drink bottles to clink together.

Later, they seemed to say something else, with Zhou Qiongqiong insisting on chasing after Feng Yue, while Wen Zhen stood nearby watching the two with smiling eyes.

Yan Lin sat in the car, separated by the car window and the busy street, watching Feng Yue in the crowd with an almost greedy gaze.

Such joyful laughter from Feng Yue was something Yan Lin hadn't seen since her rebirth. In her memory, Feng Yue hadn't smiled like this for a very long time.

Yan Lin reached out to tightly grip the fabric at her chest. This suffocating feeling that made it hard to breathe wasn't unfamiliar—she had just experienced it on the day she got the divorce certificate.

Yan Lin sat in the car quietly watching Feng Yue outside the window. For as long as the three of them played around, she watched quietly for that same duration.

By the end, she inexplicably developed a kind of hostility toward the two people who could openly stand beside Feng Yue.

Those two people's smiling faces only seemed glaring and irritating to her eyes.

Especially that woman named Wen Zhen.

The way she looked at Feng Yue made Yan Lin's almost beast-like intuition come back online. She was all too familiar with the emotions in those eyes.

Mo Yixu sat in the front passenger seat. Seeing the former wife leave with her friends outside the car window, he quietly inquired: "President Yan, shall we head back to the company?"

Yan Lin withdrew her gaze and nodded with a stern face. "Mm."

She needed to investigate who exactly that person was and what her purpose was in approaching Feng Yue.

Yan Lin gripped the two rings hanging from her neck with one hand, her emotions gradually calming down. If she remembered correctly, that person called Wen Zhen knew her little cousin.

So, just when Dai Shuangshuang was running around busy with her graduation project, she unexpectedly received a call from her sister.

Yan Lin rarely called her. The sisters usually contacted each other mostly through WeChat, so when Dai Shuangshuang saw this call, she thought something serious had happened to Yan Lin.

"Hello, sis, what's wrong?" Dai Shuangshuang held the phone with her shoulder and walked toward the dorm balcony.

"I remember you have a friend named Wen Zhen, right?" Yan Lin didn't like beating around the bush and went straight to the point.

Hearing this, Dai Shuangshuang was even more confused, but she still honestly admitted it. "Ah, yes, there is such a person. What about her?"

Dai Shuangshuang couldn't figure out how Sister Wen Zhen had any connection with her sister, and her sister's tone didn't sound like it was anything good.

"How did you meet her?"

"Oh, that. I previously joined our school's cooking club because of Sister Yue Yue's—" Dai Shuangshuang suddenly stopped.

She had already learned from her mother that the two had divorced, and her mother had even instructed her not to mention Feng Yue in front of her sister to avoid making her sad.

Hearing this, Yan Lin didn't have any other reaction and just said lightly: "Continue."

"Cough, I previously joined our school's cooking club. Our club leader knew Sister Wen Zhen and had her come teach us a few times. I was pretty slow back then, so I became familiar with her."

"What else do you know about her situation?"

Dai Shuangshuang thought for a moment. "Oh right, I heard before that Sister Wen Zhen's family runs an entertainment company, and her mother is the director of some theater troupe—anyway, it's kind of an artistic family? But she personally doesn't like these things. She only likes cooking and has even opened a Cantonese private kitchen³ in Yanjing."

Theater troupe—Yan Lin remembered that near where she had discussed business, there was indeed a theater. But as for the Cantonese private kitchen...

Yan Lin's gaze sharpened. If she remembered correctly, the place where they had their family dinner that day was a Cantonese private kitchen.

"Is that private kitchen on Yanhuai Road?" Yan Lin's tone was somewhat urgent.

"That's right! Sis, have you been there too? Her food is pretty good, isn't it!" Dai Shuangshuang was pleased, completely unaware that anything was wrong with Yan Lin.

Yan Lin gripped her phone tightly, clenching her jaw. She didn't need to ask anymore—she already knew the answer she wanted.

That woman named Wen Zhen was perhaps the "someone else" Fu Sixue had mentioned.

Combined with what she had seen by the roadside today—that gaze she was all too familiar with.

Fu Sixue was right. Feng Yue was far more outstanding and attractive than she had imagined.

Dai Shuangshuang waited a long time without getting a response from Yan Lin. She also had something she wanted to ask Yan Lin about.

She scratched her chin and tentatively said: "Sis, can I ask you a question?"

Yan Lin snapped back to attention and slowly responded: "Mm."

"Sister Yue Yue—why did she want to divorce you?"

Yan Lin lowered her gaze and reached up to cover the two rings hanging at her chest. After a long while, she said: "I disappointed her."

Yes, from the day she signed the divorce agreement, she had been thinking about why Feng Yue wanted to divorce her. Only recently had she figured it out.

This desire for divorce wasn't formed in a single day, but had erupted from day-after-day accumulation.

When disappointment accumulates enough, one leaves.

This phrase was probably the best description of Feng Yue's feelings at the time. But Yan Lin understood too late—she always attributed Feng Yue's reasons for wanting divorce to some specific incident.

But actually, it wasn't like that. The biggest reason Feng Yue left was because of her, Yan Lin.

It was because she, Yan Lin, had done too many things that disappointed Feng Yue. So Feng Yue left her without looking back.

She wouldn't blame anyone or anything else. All of this was her own doing. Taking advantage of Feng Yue's unreserved love for her, she had recklessly trampled on others.

Feng Yue divorcing her was ultimately the consequence of her own actions—she deserved it.

Feng Yue was completely unaware of all this happening. At this moment, she was gathered with Wen Zhen and Zhou Qiongqiong at a hotpot restaurant.

The suggestion to eat hotpot came from Zhou Qiongqiong, but since she was currently dieting, she could only pitifully smell the food without being able to eat anything.

"Mistake! What a mistake!" Zhou Qiongqiong sat on the sofa across from the two, watching helplessly as Feng Yue and her senior sister ate happily.

She said indignantly: "If I had known, I wouldn't have suggested coming for hotpot. You two are completely tempting me to commit a crime right now!"

"Feng Yue asked you at least three times in the car, and you insisted on coming yourself, saying you just needed to smell it. Now you're regretting it."

"Exactly, exactly."

Zhou Qiongqiong looked helplessly at the two people in front of her who spoke without even lifting their eyes to look at her, muttering discontentedly: "Senior sister, you're really my dear senior sister."

Feng Yue looked at her with amusement, then took a few slices of beef she had cooked and rinsed them in clean water, placing them in front of Zhou Qiongqiong.

"Eat them. Just three slices, chew them slowly."

Zhou Qiongqiong looked at Feng Yue with a moved expression, her eyes almost filled with tears. However, she was still cautious, afraid her senior sister would go back and report to their teacher.

Zhou Qiongqiong looked pitifully at Wen Zhen. After staring for a long while, Wen Zhen admitted defeat, turned her head away, and performed with helpless fakeness: "Oh no, what should I do? I can't see anything."

Feng Yue secretly laughed and signaled Zhou Qiongqiong to eat quickly.

Zhou Qiongqiong: ...That's really not necessary.

She thought this in her heart, but still said flatteringly: "Hehe, senior sister, I won't watch next season's 'The Birth of an Actor'⁴ without you!"

Wen Zhen gave her an eye roll.

After eating the meat, Zhou Qiongqiong felt much better and cheerfully chatted with the two again.

Perhaps because they didn't want to overstimulate her, Feng Yue and Wen Zhen also put down their chopsticks not long after.

Perhaps because they didn't feel like moving after eating, the three squeezed into this small booth to chat.

This was a very novel experience for Feng Yue. All these years, she had been following behind Yan Lin. Even if she wanted to eat hotpot and chat like this with Yan Lin, Yan Lin would never agree.

"By the way, A-Yue⁵, is there anything you need to add to your home? I'll buy it for you—consider it a housewarming gift." Zhou Qiongqiong asked, twirling her keychain.

Feng Yue waved her hand. "I don't need to add anything. My home has everything. You guys just come and play."

"No, we can't break the rules." Wen Zhen looked serious.

Zhou Qiongqiong also chimed in: "Right, listen to senior sister!"

Then, no matter how Feng Yue refused, the two were determined to give her a housewarming gift.

But at the moment, Feng Yue really couldn't think of what her home was missing.

Seeing that she was truly in a difficult position, Zhou Qiongqiong thought for a moment and then checked the time. "How about this—it's still early. Let's go shopping at the mall. If you need anything, senior sister and I will pay for it, and let the housewarming gift move into your home tonight!"

Zhou Qiongqiong acted on her words immediately. Before Feng Yue could refuse, she stood up to pay the bill and prepare to head to the mall.

Footnotes:

¹ "CP" - Short for "couple," used in fan culture to refer to a romantic pairing that fans support, whether real or fictional.

² "Cayenne" - A luxury SUV model made by Porsche, indicating Yan Lin's wealth and status.

³ "Cantonese private kitchen" (粤菜私厨) - An upscale, often exclusive restaurant specializing in Cantonese cuisine, typically requiring reservations and offering a more intimate dining experience than regular restaurants.

⁴ "The Birth of an Actor" (演员的诞生) - A real Chinese reality TV show where actors compete to showcase their acting skills, similar to talent competition shows.

⁵ "A-Yue" (阿月) - An intimate nickname for Feng Yue, showing the growing closeness between the friends.